



VENTURA COUNTY, CA · 34°16'N 119°14'W

California Fractional HR

COMPLIANCE-FIRST · STATEWIDE

The Compliance Audit — *Overview*

*Senior, compliance-first HR leadership for companies of 20 to 100 employees
— the judgment of a Chief HR Officer, without the full-time hire.*

see where you stand → reach safe ground → build the system → chart forward



THE COMPLIANCE AUDIT — OVERVIEW

Contents

A fixed-fee California compliance audit — the offer, the law behind it, the scope, and where it sits in the method. Four pages, in order.

The Compliance Audit

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PAGA, in Plain English

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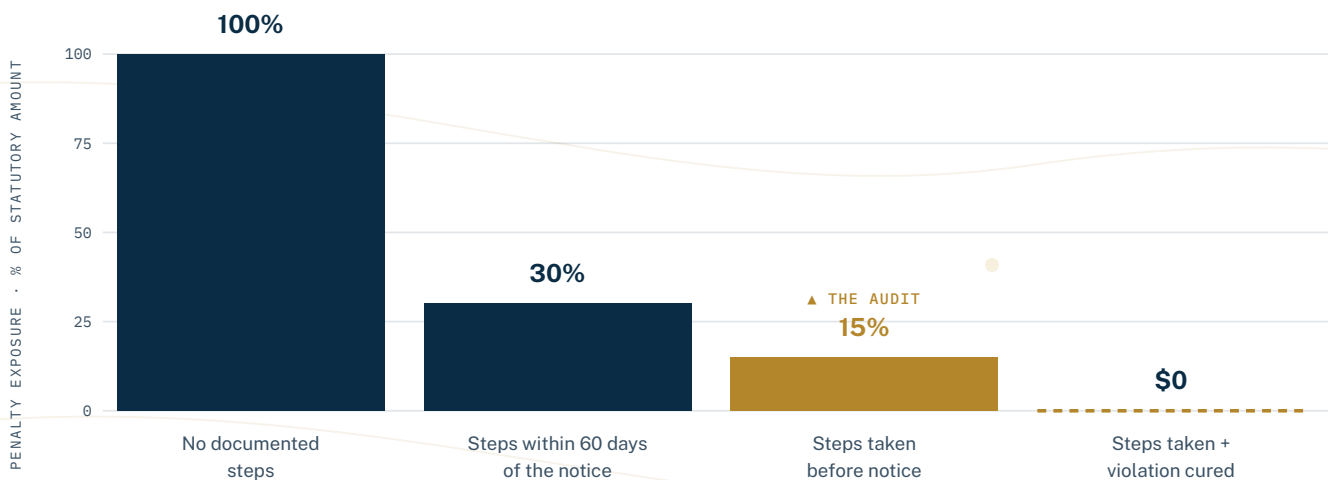


See exactly where you stand— *before a notice does.*

A fixed-fee California compliance audit that maps your exposure to the law — and produces the documented “reasonable-steps” file that can cap PAGA penalties.

PAGA 2024 REFORM • AB 2288 / SB 92

What documented reasonable steps do to your PAGA exposure



Caps apply where a court finds “all reasonable steps” were taken, evaluated on the totality of circumstances; percentages are of penalties sought. The audit builds the documented file — it does not guarantee an outcome.

California Compliance Audit

from \$4,500 fixed fee

A finite scope and a fixed fee. Converts to a retainer when you’re ready to keep it maintained.

VENTURA • SANTA BARBARA • STATEWIDE VIRTUAL

WHAT IT DELIVERS

- A findings readout with your leadership
- A ranked risk map: wage-hour, pay, safety
- A 12-month compliance calendar
- A written “reasonable-steps” record for counsel

Book your audit. Tell me your headcount — fixed scope back within one business day.

connect@calfractionalhr.com

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PAGA, in *plain English*.

The California law that can turn a small payroll mistake into a company-sized bill — and why any employer over 15 people should understand it.

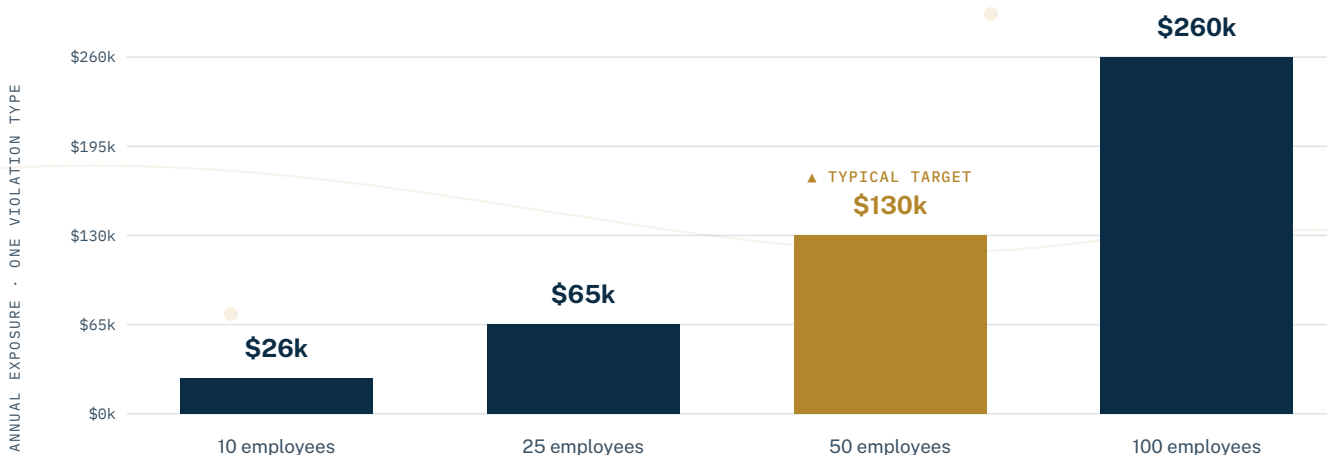
WHAT IT IS

PAGA — the Private Attorneys General Act of 2004 — lets a single employee sue on behalf of themselves, every other employee, and the State of California for violations of the state labor code. One worker is effectively deputized to enforce the law for everyone.

Two features make it bite. There is no class action to certify — a far lower bar than a normal employee lawsuit. And the bulk of any recovery goes to the State, not the workers, with the plaintiff's attorneys driving the case.

WHY THE NUMBERS EXPLODE

Penalties are charged *per employee, per pay period*. A \$100 slip, multiplied:



Illustrative: \$100 per employee, per pay period, paid bi-weekly (26 periods), for a single type of violation. Real cases often stack several violation types at once — multiplying the figures above.

THE GOOD NEWS

← SEE PAGE 3

This is exactly what the audit defuses.

Documented “reasonable steps” taken before a notice can cap these penalties at 15% — and, paired with a cure, can eliminate them. That is the entire job of the compliance audit on page three.



THE FINISHED PRODUCT

What we review — and what you *walk away with*.

A structured review across the areas where California penalizes small employers — delivered as a documented file your counsel can rely on, not a slide deck.

WHAT WE REVIEW

01

Wage & Hour

Overtime, meal & rest breaks, timekeeping, final pay.

04

Classification

Exempt status & independent-contractor tests.

02

Pay Transparency

SB 1162 pay-scale postings, ranges & records.

05

Leaves & Accommodation

Paid sick leave, CFRA, reasonable accommodation.

03

Workplace Violence

SB 553 plan, annual training, incident log.

06

Policy & Handbook

Required policies, acknowledgments, recordkeeping.

WHAT YOU RECEIVE

→ Findings Readout

A 60-minute walkthrough with your leadership. Plain English, no jargon.

→ Ranked Risk Map

Every finding scored by severity and effort, so you fix the costly items first.

→ 12-Month Compliance Calendar

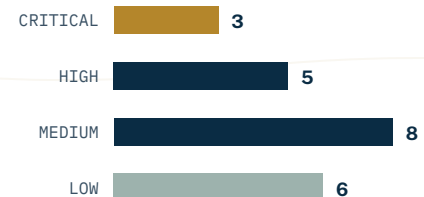
Recurring duties — SB 553 training, posting refreshes — mapped to dates. Delivered current; the retainer is what keeps it live.

→ Reasonable-Steps Report

The written record for counsel — documents the review and the actions taken. It closes the list for a reason.

RANKED RISK MAP

ILLUSTRATIVE SAMPLE



CLOSING THE FINDINGS — TWO WAYS

Every finding comes with a fix. Run it yourself, or we execute it with you.

OPTION A

Close it in-house

You get a prioritized, plain-English remediation plan mapped to owners and dates. Your team executes; we're on call for questions.

BEST WITH CAPABLE IN-HOUSE HR / OPS

OPTION B • RETAINER

We close it with you

We execute the fixes alongside your team. The audit converts straight into a retainer.

\$175/hr project close-out • or \$3,500/mo • 20 hrs, HR Director

→ *a documented reasonable-steps position, maintained.*



The ground everything else *stands on*.

The California Compass runs in four bearings — diagnose, stabilize, systematize, elevate. Each stands on the one below it, and it all starts on compliant ground.



Every bearing stands on the one below it.

BEARING 01 — DIAGNOSE — IS THE COMPLIANCE AUDIT

WHAT YOU'RE ACTUALLY BUYING

Compliance isn't the ambitious part of HR. It's the part that lets the ambitious parts exist — the quiet confidence to hire, promote, discipline and grow without a filing waiting to happen.

- **You stop watching the mailbox.**
The demand letter stops living rent-free in your head.
- **Your managers act with confidence.**
Hard conversations happen on solid, documented ground.
- **You scale without compounding risk.**
Each new hire adds capability, not exposure.

PUT THE WEIGHT DOWN

Buy back the peace of mind.

You didn't start the company to master California's Labor Code. The audit hands that weight to someone who has — one fixed fee, one documented file, one fewer thing keeping you up at night.

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